10. Secretaries of State for Home, Foreign, Defence, Social Services, Environment and Education and Science

11. Ministers of Agriculture and Fisheries, Health, Pension, Transport and Labour

12. Secretary of State of Scotland

13. Secretary of State for Wales

It must be mentioned here that the Attorney-General, Solicitor-General, Lord Advocate and Paymaster-General are not members of the British Cabinet.

Privy Council There is a close relationship between the Cabinet and the Privy Council. This council, in its present form, came into existence in the fifteenth century as an advisory body to the British monarch. In the course of time, most of its powers were transferred to the cabinet as its inner committee. Presently, it consists of 330 members and includes, *inter alia*, all cabinet ministers (past and present). It is presided over by the Lord President of the Council.

Prime Ministerial Government In the past, the British Constitutional and political experts had described the relationship between the Prime Minister and the Cabinet as '*Primus inter pares*' (first among equals). In the recent period, the Prime Minister's power, influence and position have increased significantly *vis-a-vis* the cabinet. He/she has come to play a 'dominant' role in the British Politico-administrative system. Hence, the later political analysts, like Crossman, Mackintosh and others have described the British Cabinet Government as 'Prime Ministerial Government'.

Shadow Cabinet It is a unique institution of the British Cabinet system. It is formed by the opposition party to balance the ruling cabinet and to prepare its members for future ministerial office. In Britain, the opposition enjoys an official recognition and is as well organised as the government. It runs a 'Parallel' government with its shadow cabinet. In this shadow cabinet, almost every member in the ruling cabinet is 'shadowed' by a corresponding member in the opposition cabinet. The members of the shadow cabinet watch critically the working of the departments assigned to them. They match the cabinet ministers in the parliamentary debates. The shadow cabinet serves as the 'alternative cabinet' if there is change of government. That is why Ivor Jennings described the leader of opposition as the 'alternative' Prime Minister. He/she enjoys the status of a Minister and is paid by the government.

French Constitution

The French Revolution (1789–1799) had a significant impact on the growth of the French constitutional system. Since the revolution, France has changed its Constitution on an average after every 12 years. It adopted three monarchic, two dictatorial, three imperial and four republican Constitutions. The present French Constitution, which established the Fifth Republic, came into force in 1958. It was prepared under the instructions of General de Gaulle. It was designed to give France a strong and stable Government.

The salient features of the Constitution of the Fifth French Republic are as follows:

1. Written Constitution Like the American Constitution, the French Constitution is a written Constitution. Originally, it contained a Preamble and 92 Articles divided into 15 chapters. It declares 'Liberty, Equality and Fraternity' as the motto of the Fifth Republic. It states, "France is an indivisible, secular, democratic and social republic". The chapters of the Constitution are mentioned in Table 95.1.